

Exit-Readiness Action Plan

High Key-Person Risk — Your Business Is a Job, Not an Asset

Key-Person Dependency:  85% HIGH RISK

You built a successful electrical contracting business. But somewhere along the way, the business started running you instead of the other way around. You're the senior sparkie, the quoting department, the compliance officer, and the person who fields every crisis call — every single day. You can't take a holiday without the phone ringing. You can't get sick without jobs stalling. And deep down, you know that if you tried to sell tomorrow, a buyer would see a job — not a business worth paying a premium for.

Your quiz results confirm what you already feel: your business depends entirely on you. Buyers see this and discount heavily — or walk away entirely. The good news? Every problem the quiz identified has a specific fix. Better news: the destination is closer than you think.

THE DESTINATION: WHAT A SYSTEMISED BUSINESS FEELS LIKE

Picture this. It's a Tuesday morning in January. You're at the beach with your kids. Your phone stays in your pocket — the jobs are scheduled, the crew knows exactly what to do, compliance certificates are filing themselves, and invoices are going out at job completion. Nobody is calling because nobody needs to. The business is running on systems — not on you. When the time comes to sell, a buyer looks at your operation and sees a well-oiled machine: documented workflows, predictable margins, a trained team, and a business that doesn't miss a beat whether the owner is in the office or on a plane to Bali. They pay a premium because they're buying a business, not a job. Electrical contractors just like you make this transition every year. The ones who succeed all do three things.

YOUR DIAGNOSIS

Your business is currently a job, not a sellable asset. It relies on your time, energy, and personal memory. Quoting happens in your head. Compliance paperwork lives in WhatsApp. If you took a month off, the business would stall — because the system IS you. Buyers buy systems, not people. The fix starts with three things: get off the tools, centralise your pricing, and build job workflows that don't depend on you being there. Every one of these is achievable in 3–6 months with the right software — and the result is a business that works for you, not the other way around.

YOUR TOP 3 PRIORITY ACTIONS (AND THE RESULT YOU GET)

1. Centralise your quoting rules and pricing

Stop building quotes from memory — that's how margins leak. Set up standardised pricing templates with pre-loaded supplier costs, labour rates, and margin targets in ServiceM8. When every quote follows the same rules, you stop being the bottleneck, and you stop leaving money on the table.

→ **Result:** You win jobs at the right margin without touching a calculator. Your team quotes consistently — whether you're in the office or on holiday.

2. Build systemised SOPs in ServiceM8

Every job type needs a documented workflow: what happens at booking, what forms are required on site, what photos must be captured, and what sign-off steps close the job. Build these once in ServiceM8, and every technician — including ones you haven't hired yet — follows the same process.

→ **Result:** Your business runs the same whether you're there or not. New hires hit the ground running. Compliance is never a last-minute panic.

3. Track job profitability per job type

You can't fix margins you can't see. Connect ServiceM8 to Xero or MYOB so labour hours and supplier costs are tracked against every job in real time. Within 3 months, you'll know exactly which job types make money and which are quietly bleeding it.

→ **Result:** You stop doing unprofitable work. Every job you take contributes to your bottom line — and to your eventual sale price.

Continue Reading on TradieAutomate:

- 1 [ServiceM8 for Electricians — Full Guide](#)
- 2 [How to Sell Your ServiceM8-Based Trade Business](#)
- 3 [Hidden Costs Killing Your Profit as a Solar Installer or Electrician](#)

Ready to systemise your business?

[Start your free 14-day ServiceM8 trial](#) →

14-day free trial. No credit card. Unlimited staff.

This action plan is a starting point. For the complete 12-chapter system covering licensing, cash flow, tech stack, hiring, and building a business worth selling — download [The Sparky's Playbook](#) (free)